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WILLIAM FOSTER TO SPEAK AT ACM ANNUAL CONFERENCE

Natick, MA - October 18, 1982 - Stratus Computer President William E. Foster will address the Association of Computing Machinery (ACM) Annual Conference in Dallas, Texas on October 27. He will speak to the General Session on the topic "New Computer Architectures: The Vanishing Central Processor".

The three-day ACM national conference has as a main theme "The Computer Industry: Solving or Creating Today's Problems". Foster is one of the two featured speakers at the conference. In addition to the general session, there are some 40 technical sessions featuring panels, tutorials, refereed papers, awards, and a vendor exhibition. Total conference attendance is estimated at 2,000 by the ACM.

In his speech, Foster states that there is now an improved technique for designing powerful supermini and mainframe class computers. "By using multiple 16 or 32 bit processor chips executing in parallel, major advances in price, performance, and reliability have been achieved. Older products rely on a single, custom CENTRAL processor which must share its time among many users and tasks. The only way to improve performance is to replace the central processor with a more powerful one. By contrast, systems using the latest high performance microprocessor chips can distribute work over many processor chips, and system

performance can be easily enhanced by adding more chips." Foster concludes that "like the vacuum tube, the transistor, and the gate array, the processor chip has become a high level building block in the most advanced high performance computers. In addition, parallel processing has allowed us to increase the reliability of on-line systems by 10 to 100 times, a level of reliability which is mandatory as society increases its dependence on computers."

Mr. Foster is President and co-founder of Stratus Computer, Inc. He was previously employed by Data General Corporation as Vice President of Software, and by Hewlett-Packard Company where he was Computer Systems Engineering Manager for the HP3000 product line. Mr. Foster has a Master's Degree in Mathematics and an MBA from the University of Santa Clara.

Stratus Computer, with headquarters in Natick, MA, designs, manufactures, and markets the Stratus/32 Continuous Processing line of fault tolerant computers. The company has offices in major US cities.

For more information or a copy of the full text of the speech contact:

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